

## AUDIOSCRIPT

[NB underlined sections show the answers]

### SECTION 1

**You will hear a new student, Tom, talking to a student representative called Rachel about university clubs.**

- Rachel: Hi, welcome to Freshers Week. I'm Rachel. Can I help you?
- Tom: Oh, hi – yes. Erm – I was hoping to find out about some clubs I could join.
- Rachel: Well, all the club stands are here in this hall. What were you interested in?
- Tom: Um – not sure. I wanted to do something where I could meet people.
- Rachel: Well, take this leaflet with details of all the clubs and see what you think. It'll probably depend on what day you're free. Like on Mondays there's the film club, then on Tuesdays you've got the climbing club – that's really good, I'm in that – then on Wednesdays you've got chess, if you want something a bit more intellectual! But you should look through carefully because all the clubs run extra activities as well as their normal meetings.
- Tom: Oh, yes I see. [as if reading] So it looks like the film club has discussions after the films – I'd quite like to go to those. Then climbing – goodness, it says here that the University has its own climbing wall – that's impressive – and they go on weekend trips. Cool. And it says the chess club normally just does games with whoever turns up but it also runs competitions sometimes. But I bet you've got to be pretty good to do that.
- Rachel: Yes, I think so!
- Tom: And how many people are in the clubs? Are they all really full?
- Rachel: Well, obviously they're all different so, for example, the film club has just increased its membership from eighty five to a hundred and twenty five but I think they're hoping to extend it to a hundred and fifty. The climbing club's quite small – forty people – and the chess club is fairly healthy at fifty five.
- Tom: Right. OK, so who do I see if I want to join these clubs?
- Rachel: Well, if you go round the stands and speak to the people there. For the film club that's the events organiser – um, for climbing you'll need the club secretary and the chess club is organised by one of the Maths tutors. OK?
- Tom: Yup. I think I'll start with the climbing club – it sounds good.
- Rachel: Oh well, as I said, I'm in that so I might be able to help you a bit.
- Tom: OK. It says in the leaflet that they get together twice a month. Is that right?
- Rachel: Yes. Oh, you must join. It's really good fun. We go away quite a bit to North Wales and every year we have a special excursion, usually to France, which is where we're going this year in the spring. The weather's too unpredictable in the autumn.
- Tom: Wow! That sounds good – but it must cost a lot.
- Rachel: Yeah, but we try and save up for it through subscriptions so rather than having a huge sum to pay in the month we go we collect those weekly so it spreads it out.
- Tom: Good idea. I think I'll definitely join.
- Rachel: There are quite good benefits you get from joining. I mean, you need that don't you? And the University clubs normally try and do deals with local businesses, so it's really worth joining. Like in the climbing club they've got a special arrangement with one of the shops in town so if you show your card you can get money off equipment. Don't think the discount extends to clothes though.
- Tom: That's really worth it then. I'll go over and talk to them now.
- Rachel: OK. Hope you do join. Oh, and another thing I meant to say. If you do become a member, you automatically receive a magazine once a year. It's quite useful and interesting because it goes out to all the national climbing clubs. And the other thing is, if you come to every session, then you can get a complimentary ticket to the big exhibition that's held in Cardiff every year. So – hope to see you ...
- Tom: Yeah, thanks ... (fade) ...



## SECTION 2

**You will hear an accommodation officer telling students about different halls of residence.**

Accommodation Officer:

Good afternoon and welcome to Stanton University. I'm here to tell you about the various halls of residence we have available should you choose to come here. We aim to offer accommodation in Halls to all first year students and you'll find there's a good variety to choose from.

First of all, there's Brown Hall, which, as you'll see, is not the most modern of buildings but it is very popular with some students. It's got a good sense of community, some nice refurbished kitchens and, unlike the other halls, it has recently had a gym built in its basement. Another option is Blake Residence, which is built like a large house and so everybody cooks and eats together. It has its own sectioned-off bit of private garden and is even more peaceful because this is an all girls residence, although of course boys are allowed to visit the Hall and, I understand, frequently take part in cooking dinner! The largest Hall we have is Queens Building and this has been upgraded recently. The original parking area has been built on so that the hall now has a large common room and each bedroom now has its own shower room, which many students regard as a real bonus. A further option is the Parkway Flats, which won an award for design in its day and this building now has a preservation order on it. This has meant that only a limited amount could be done to upgrade it and the surrounding area is important so parking is not permitted around the Flats. However, the Flats do have many extra facilities such as a special computer room, a small library and a self-service restaurant. The cost of breakfast, lunch and dinner is covered in the fees for this hall so it does look a bit more expensive. The last residence we can offer you is Temple Rise, which again is slightly more expensive than other Halls as the rooms are larger. This has got very lovely views across to the coast and this more than compensates for the fact that bathrooms here are shared between six students. However, the Hall has domestic staff who clean the rooms once a week so this is perhaps an attractive option for the messier amongst you.

Now if I can just show on this wall map here where they all are, you might like to go and have a look round. If you come into the main university entrance, at the first junction you'll find that Brown Hall is on the corner opposite the theatre. So you're nice and near the station here – though I think it can get a bit noisy with traffic. The same applies to Blake Residence, which is directly facing the junction to the university entrance. These Halls are often used by medical students and such like as they're out all day so don't notice the noise. Anyway, if you then walk along Campus Road towards the main Circle, you'll see the library on the corner and Queens Building is just past that as you head north. You will find that it is quieter here and you may get fewer visitors! By the way the Circle is quite a feature of the campus as it's set into the hills and has a brand new sports centre in the middle – it's worth going to look around it.

Now, the Parkway Flats are on the opposite corner to the library, facing the Circle, as you head towards the main buildings. The main buildings are only about a five-minute walk from here and places in these Halls go quickly so my advice is to reserve your place as soon as possible. Then Temple Rise is inside the Circle, next to the sports centre, but further from the main University buildings. Now, if you'd like to go off and ... (fade) ...

## SECTION 3

**You will hear two students, Jenna and Marco, discussing a Business Studies project they have to do.**

Jenna: Come on Marco. We've got to get on and sort out this project for Professor Barclay.

Marco: Hang on. I want to make sure we've got all the information. Now .. (sitting down) ... where are we?



Jenna: Well, today we need to sort out exactly what we're going to do and how we're going to divide the work up.

Marco: OK. How long have we got, by the way?

Jenna: Um .. the end of term is April 6<sup>th</sup> and he said to hand it in on week 8, so that's March 25<sup>th</sup> at the latest because the beginning of that week is 21<sup>st</sup>. So not long!

Marco: Right. Have you got the notes there?

Jenna: Yes, he wants us to do a fairly small-scale study, like the last one, on whether or not businesses were offering more benefits to staff. We've now got to look at the rise in older workers. Should be fairly straightforward.

Marco: Yeah, as long as we keep it small. Who's marking it?

Jenna: Don't know – sometimes he gets the PhD students to mark it for him.

Marco: Oh actually it just says here 'a senior lecturer'. I suppose it's too much for Professor Barclay to do them all.

Jenna: Yeah. Anyway, how are we going to go about this?

Marco: Well, we have to decide how big we want it to be and who we're ...

Jenna: (cutting him off) ... Yeah, but I think we must sort out a timetable for the project otherwise nothing will get done.

Marco: OK. Do you want to do that?

Jenna: Alright. I'll do it as soon as we finish here.

OK – what do we have to do now for the project? What's the best way to go about it?

Marco: Um ... well, Professor Carter suggested we set up a focus group to get some in-depth interviews but I think that'll take a lot of time.

Jenna: Yeah, I agree. If we did a focus group, we'd have to spend time deciding who to include in it and it's not necessary to do one anyway.

Marco: Oh, fine.

Jenna: And, if you agree, I think we should get in touch with the businesses on the list Professor Carter gave us and ask them if they're prepared to participate.

Marco: Sounds good – then we can go there, give them questionnaires and collect them later.

Jenna: Exactly.

Marco: OK. Then do we need to book one of those study rooms in the library so we can work together to input the data? Perhaps not, as I guess just one of us could just sort it out, actually.

Jenna: Yes, that would be easier. A lot of what we're doing is qualitative, so it'll be writing up rather than statistics. No software for that I'm afraid!

Marco: And I think it would look better if we had actual shots of some of the staff because we're citing appearance as a factor in employability, aren't we?

Jenna: Yeah. OK. I'll factor that all in when I sort everything out tonight.

Marco: I'm glad we decided to work together. I think it's going to work out well.

Jenna: Yes, well, given that we had to work in pairs on this project, I think we were right to choose each other. We complement each other academically as we're each good at what the other isn't! In fact, we should have tried working together before!

Marco: Yes! Now, how shall we split the work? I'll do the analysis, shall I?

Jenna: Oh – OK.

Marco: It's just that it might be faster because I'm used to doing it – although your English is better than mine. I need more practice at reading, really.

Jenna: OK. I'll do the presentation then. If that's OK with you?

Marco: Yeah, sure. I don't mind speaking in public but I hate preparing all the notes for them.

Jenna: Thing is, the tutor said one person should do the whole presentation and he's said he expects me to do it because I haven't done one yet.

Marco: No, that's fine. Now ... (fade) ...

## SECTION 4

**You will hear a media studies tutor giving a lecture about news sources.**

Lecturer: OK, now many of you will have heard about the predicted death of newspapers as people increasingly access the TV and the internet for their news. Today I want to look at the USA, which has very advanced news sources, to see if this is actually true.

In the USA the main news sources without doubt are TV, the internet and the press – that is traditional newspapers. And, although they are each surviving and growing, they are also changing. Obviously TV news has been around for a while, and the early evening bulletins when people get in from work are very popular. I suppose we traditionally think of the morning newspaper arriving on our doorstep with the daily news. Interestingly, this is not borne out by the statistics, which show that readership in the US is much higher when people have time to relax, when they're not working, especially on Sundays. The internet is also a popular weekend activity but shows no variation with weekday access. So people are using the different sources in different ways. Interestingly, local radio has been hit less by the grip of quite strong local newspapers than by the internet, which is seen to offer a better regional service. But just because the internet is seen as the new force in news media does not mean it is dominant. Television has, of course, been global for a while, but now technological changes, which have fuelled the rise of online news, have also allowed newspapers to print and distribute editions across the world. In fact, internet news, which is seen as the big competitor for traditional markets, does not offer that much variety. Often the sources are the online versions of the newspapers, whereas television, in order to offer something different, has had to come up with a much more mixed bag of reporting from hard news to light reports on celebrity events. Another issue is reliability – the internet is virtually unregulated so anything can be reported there, whether true or not. Journalists on newspapers have fought a long hard battle to fight intervention and to retain the freedom of the press. Television, however, is seen as critical to political power and has become subject to harsh controls about what it can or cannot say.

Now one very critical factor in keeping newspapers alive and well in the USA has been their approach to advertising. Obviously newspapers are heavily dependent on advertising revenue and they have become more and more imaginative in what they offer, in order to make sure that advertisers use them, and not other news sources. This has meant that, contrary to popular belief, newspapers now have a significantly higher profit margin than the rest of American industry. So how have they managed to raise advertising revenue in this way? Well, they have put a lot of effort into developing and maintaining a very strong association with the retail trade. And they've come up with a winner. A critical tool in their sales plan has been suggesting that the adverts they run can have vouchers. This has been enormously effective because they have found that, not only do more people buy the paper to get the discounts but also that this inevitably means much higher sales for the clients who advertised. As well as doing this, the newspapers have also introduced aggressive sales campaigns over the last few years. This has resulted in a significant and continuing rise in the number of advertisers prepared to pay the extra for full-page ads. So, what I would like ... (fade) ...



## AUDIOSCRIPT

### SECTION 1

**You will hear a new student, Stefan, talking to an assistant, Anna, at the Student Union about his membership.**

- Anna: Hi, can I help you?
- Stefan: Um – yeah, I hope so. Erm – this is the first time I've been down to the Union – I'm a new international student – and I just wondered what to do.
- Anna: Oh right. Well, normally we ask international students to fill out this form and we put your details on the wall by reception. Then other students can contact you – it's a way for everybody to get to know each other. It can be a bit lonely otherwise.
- Stefan: Oh I see.
- Anna: What's your name? I'm Anna, by the way.
- Stefan: It's Stefan Unger.
- Anna: OK – well just write that there – next to name – and then fill in the rest.
- Stefan: Right. Um – what does it mean degree programme?
- Anna: Oh, just if you are an undergraduate or a post-graduate – or maybe you're just here for a short course?
- Stefan: I'm a postgraduate. Do I need to say what in?
- Anna: Not really – it's too much detail. But you should put your department so people who have the same interests – or problems – as you can get in touch.
- Stefan: So I'm studying Marine Construction so, for Department, do I put down the Science faculty then?
- Anna: Just your actual Department. That must be Engineering, no?
- Stefan: Oh I see, yes.
- Anna: Then if you list what you like doing in your free time – not that we ever get any when we're studying – and maybe you can meet up with someone socially or to join a club or something.
- Stefan: Well, I like lots of things – shall I just list them?
- Anna: My advice is to just put one or two like football and films or whatever. Otherwise you'll get so many invitations you won't get any time to work!
- Stefan: OK – I think I'll just list computer games as that's my big interest. I haven't played football for ages. I may start to play once I get settled. Now, let's see – next thing is languages.
- Anna: Yes – we find many of the international students get a bit tired of speaking English all the time – sometimes they like to speak to someone in their own language. It's up to you.
- Stefan: That is a good idea. I presume I don't need to put English down?
- Anna: Oh no – (laughs) – I put – um – Italian and French.
- Stefan: Hm – I can only speak German – my mother tongue.
- Anna: OK, well that's fine. Just put that.
- Stefan: What does accommodation mean? Is that my address?
- Anna: We're trying to find similarities between people and some people live in Hall, some are in flats, some are in bed-sits – so it helps if you say.
- Stefan: I'm in Hall, though I'd like to be in a flat. But that won't happen till the end of the first term.
- Anna: Put where you are now. You can always change it later. Then finally just put your phone number.
- Stefan: I haven't really got one – I haven't sorted out a mobile yet.
- Anna: Well, it's going to be difficult for people to contact you then, isn't it? Why don't you put the Union one and we'll take messages for you.
- Stefan: OK.
- Anna: It's 02950 659003. Have you got that?
- Stefan: Yes.
- Anna: OK, then.

Stefan: Oh I had a couple more questions about the services you've got here. Um – it says there's a photocopier here ...

Anna: Yes. You need to get a card from the shop – and then it's available to all students in the mornings. The Union uses it after 1.00 pm.

Stefan: OK. I see also the Union organises loads of events. Are they always held here in the Union building? It looks big enough!

Anna: If you're interested in something, you should check the poster or our website. In fact, we normally use the Round Theatre opposite the Conference Centre for most events because the sound system is better.

Stefan: Right, I'll do that. Also I wanted to hire a van. Can I do that through you?

Anna: Erm – no. You need to present a case really – they're not just available for hire to anyone. The President said we have to limit who is allowed to hire them. The person you need to see is the Transport Secretary. She's on the second floor.

Stefan: OK, thanks. The other thing is, are all the discounts we get with our Union card listed on the back of the card? I thought there might be more.

Anna: No, that's it I'm afraid – mainly books, clothes and music. Though we are currently negotiating to get one on newspapers, so that should be valid from next term.

Stefan: OK, thanks a lot ... (fade) ...

## SECTION 2

**You will hear a library assistant talking about the library she works in.**

Library assistant: Hi. Can I help you?

Student: Erm – yes – I wanted to join the library.

Library assistant: OK. First of all, let me show you round the library and explain a few things for you. (pause) OK, now we're here at the main entrance. You can see the reception, which is where you bring back and take out books and also we can order books and answer your questions there. Next to the reception, where you can see those old desks, is where we keep the magazines because you can sit down and read there. They're divided into sections for Sciences, Geography, Arts, etcetera. Then, at the back of the library you can see the section for old books. Next to that is where the books proper start. That used to be the Science section but now on those shelves you'll find the Arts section. We had a big re-organisation in the summer, which I think has made it clearer. The numbering is standard so you should be able to find what you want quite easily. However, if you can't find something, it probably means it's been borrowed. OK, then in the corner, next to the reference section, is where we thought it was quietest, and away from the phones and printers and things, so we've put the study desks there. They all have computer access, if you need it for your laptop. We do ask that you don't just read magazines there, though. OK, then there's the reference section where you can look up the files. Then, as we come back to the main entrance, is the next section, where we used to have the languages. It got very busy and noisy, so when we moved everything round we decided to put the law books here. Also, because it's a smaller section it fits quite well here. OK, then we're back at the main entrance. Over there, by reception, there's a door that goes to the extension and we have further sections, such as Languages, and study desks through there so you could have a look round when we've finished. Then just between reception and the door here is where we decided to put the computers but the computer magazines are in the magazine section as we found too many went missing here! OK, is that everything ...

Student: That's great thanks. Can you just tell me a bit about borrowing and the rules and whatever?

Library assistant: Of course. Over the last two months we've been introducing a new system for this and you



can now take books out for six weeks. That's generally enough for most people – we usually get books back within thirty days. Of course, you may decide to renew the period. You used to have to come in to get the book stamped because we don't like doing it over the phone as there's no record of it. But now you can do all that via email. If you do forget to renew, then we do make a charge, I'm afraid. That helps our costs, of course, – but we do insist on it. The good news is that there is only one charge – I know some libraries charge £1 for one week and then it goes up with each week it's late! We ask for £1.50 as we think that's high enough to stop people being overdue. The other thing you may want to know is what you do about books that are not on the shelves. We do have a system for reserving them. All you have to do is fill in a yellow form, behind those blue ones on the desk, and give it to someone at reception. We'll let you know when it comes in. Also, sometimes you will need a journal article that we don't have but can get from other libraries, so we offer an ordering service if you need it. Now if you'd like to ... (fade) ...

### SECTION 3

**You will hear two students, Ramil and Kirsten, discussing presenting a paper at an architecture conference.**

- Ramil: Hi, Kirsten. Have you heard about that Architecture conference in Oxford at the end of the year?
- Kirsten: Yeah. I saw the leaflet on the noticeboard. As it's my final year, I ought to try giving a paper. But I've got no idea how to go about it!
- Ramil: I think you should go for it. I did one last year. It's quite straightforward. First of all, you need to see what the conference themes are – you know, what topics they are covering. You can do that by looking it up on the website. You need to submit a paper that falls into one of the categories they give you.
- Kirsten: Oh, that may give me some ideas.
- Ramil: Then, while you're doing that, you should also have a look at the information on how to submit your paper – the 'rules', if you like, such as the length. It's important you follow those.
- Kirsten: I see. Then I suppose the next stage is to start writing it up. I'd like to use it as an opportunity to propose some future work, but I understand it must be based on current work. Still there's plenty to choose from. It makes sense to do something that I'm more familiar with.
- Ramil: Yes, – and the other thing is, when you've written it up, then go back and look at your data carefully and make certain that you've presented it in a format that is standard for your subject. Remember people have to absorb information very quickly while they're listening – don't make it too complicated.
- Kirsten: OK, well, I reckon that'll take me about a month to get that sorted. Then, the next thing I have to do, I guess, before I send it off to the conference organiser, is give the whole thing to the Events Officer so that he can look through it and see if it all makes sense and is OK.
- Ramil: Yeah. Remember to warn him that it's en route so he can fit it into his schedule! Then you're done really. All you have to do after that is to go through it and sort out any changes you need to make. Then finally you can submit it. You can do that online.
- Kirsten: Phew! Good. Then I just wait to hear I suppose. How long does that take?
- Ramil: Depends – but usually about six weeks. When you hear, if your paper has been accepted, then, at that stage, it's worth giving them a list of any technical things you'll need when you actually give the talk – a screen or video players or that sort of thing.
- Kirsten: OK – but that's a long way off. And I know that, if my paper is accepted, then, at that stage, I have to give them a short text about myself and my academic background, so that they can put it in the brochure. Famous, at last!
- Ramil: Yeah.
- Kirsten: Right – well, I've got to get a couple of things sorted if I'm going to get this paper completed.



- Ramil: Have you got enough data?
- Kirsten: Possibly. I'd like to reinforce some of it, though, so I thought I'd send out some more questionnaires. I was looking at that thesis that Angela wrote last year and she said you need a sample of over 100 to be sure of your results.
- Ramil: I think some of this year's postgraduates are doing some of the same stuff as you on buildings. Why don't you talk to them?
- Kirsten: I'll end up getting confused. It would be more useful for me to actually go out to that site by the rail bridge to see how they're building the new factory. I managed to get hold of Professor Barnett at London University and he said I should go out and take pictures. I'm pretty busy but I'll have to make time. Anyway, what about you ... (fade) ...

## SECTION 4

**You will hear part of a lecture on the current and future use of mobile phones.**

Lecturer: OK, now today we're looking at changes in communication, and specifically changes that have just happened or are likely to happen in the next few years. Key to this is the mobile phone, which is increasingly being seen as an all-purpose system rather than just a phone. If you only use your phone for texting and making calls now, you will be amazed at how you will be using it in the future. The technology has been developed for a range of other uses. For example, phones could be used so that if you are meeting someone and they get lost you could send them a map of your location to help them. This will save all those complicated explanations over the phone and our poor friends or colleagues trying to drive and find out where they are at the same time. And, if you get bored waiting, or if you are travelling for example, you will soon be able to see TV news on your phone as it is actually being broadcast. This means that you won't have to miss any of your favourites if you are away for a few days. Most people have got used to texting now, and young people send pictures to each other but, what is exciting, is the possibility of putting music with them before you send them. And it's not all frivolous. Phones are going to become even more critical in business and education. Some recent developments have a highly practical usage so, for example, as lecturers we will be able to send everybody a text to let them know if lectures have been cancelled. And the new phones could have a further use in education, as well as business, as they will enable us to go to any destination – such as when we are doing a field trip for instance – and from there to send data directly to a computer so that we can access it when we get home. This means we will no longer be limited by what the phone can store.

And it's interesting to look at the different ways that men and women use phones now, as that does affect how the technology will develop. Some research has been done on how people use phones and some of the results are surprising. One of the increasing usages of mobile phones is to get all sorts of data such as phone numbers, the weather, train times, etcetera and, while there's been an attempt to set up connections with things that women might be interested in accessing, it is overwhelmingly men who do this. But what about the traditional use of a phone – to speak to people! I suppose we would predict that it is mainly women who use phones as a method of contact for friends and family but, in fact, the genders exploit this facility equally. I've spoken about the increased business usages that phones will offer and I suppose we would associate this usage with men. The survey picked up though that women are often working from home or catching up with work in the evenings so they use phones in this way as much as men do. Most of us are aware we can store photos on our phones – it's an ideal method of capturing a moment, wherever you are. Women tend to be the group that keep photos on their phones, but it seems that men use their phones to actually take pictures much more than women do. And, of course, all this knowledge affects the marketing that the companies will do ... (fade) ...



## AUDIOSCRIPT

### SECTION 1

**You will hear a science student enquiring about English courses at a University language centre**

- Student: Hi, I've come to ask about the English courses you run for international students.
- Administrator: Oh right – I assume you're a student at the university?
- Student: Yes, I've just started.
- Administrator: OK. Well, we've got a range of courses. It depends what you think you need. And how much. Um – we can't run everything at the same time though so, for example, in this first term we are just doing a writing course.
- Student: I see. That sounds quite useful. What else is there?
- Administrator: Um, some of the courses only run for single terms and we tend to focus on what students have difficulty with. That means we don't usually do speaking courses but next term you can do listening. That'll help you with lectures and things. Our provision is all based on what the majority of our international students need.
- Student: So is everything term-based – there's nothing that you run all year?
- Administrator: Well, let's have a look. Yes, there is a class for vocabulary and grammar every term. That's for everybody but it's split into three or four levels.
- Student: And what about in the holidays?
- Administrator: We don't do anything during the winter or spring break but over the summer there's just general classes because that's what most students want – a bit of everything.
- Student: OK. Quite a variety then. I'll have a think about what I really need because I haven't got much time. Do you have about twenty students in each class – the same as our Science seminars?
- Administrator: We try to keep it at about twelve and certainly not more than fifteen. It's important for language classes. They're very different from your normal courses.
- Student: Right – and how much are the classes?
- Administrator: The rate varies depending on how many hours you attend but you shouldn't have to pay – usually the department will fund you and even sort out which classes you need.
- Student: Brilliant! It would be quite useful for me to have a certificate to take back to my country. Do you put us in for exams?
- Administrator: Yes. But we don't like them to clash with your main course exams in June, so we run them in May. That leaves you time for revision.
- Student: Do I have to sign up for something now? I'm not quite sure what I want.
- Administrator: Classes haven't quite started yet so you've got time to decide what you do. All we insist is that you sign up before week five. That gives you about three weeks to decide.
- Student: OK.
- Administrator: Then, when you've made up your mind, you need to come back here to the administration office to enrol.
- Student: What do I need to bring with me when I enrol? My identity card, I guess?
- Administrator: Yes, or your passport. Then you'll be given a registration form which you'll have to show to the teacher when you have your first class.
- Student: OK. And should I ask my tutor about which classes I should do then?
- Administrator: Yes, then you get a note from him and give that to the desk when you register.
- Student: Can I use the computers here as well?



Administrator: Yes, you'll be given a password when you go to your first class, so remember to bring a disk with you to save your work on as you won't be allowed to save it on the hard drive.

Student: OK. Will I need anything else? Dictionary?

Administrator: We've got loads of those here that you can borrow, but you'll need a notebook as we don't provide paper or files.

Student: OK. Thanks.

## SECTION 2

**You will hear a man giving some information about transport in London.**

Man: Hello, can I help you?

Student: Yes, I was wondering what the best way was for me to get around London.

Man: Well, there are a lot of possibilities. As you probably realise, the main ways to get around are bus, train and tube – the underground. It depends how much you want to spend. All forms of transport offer special tickets, such as cheap day returns on the trains and so on. Overall, you'll spend less on the bus as it operates on a basic flat fare for each journey. But, of course, it may not go to where you need to travel to. The mainline trains only operate in the outlying areas, though a few cross London, whereas the tube has stations which are placed in central areas of the city close to the main sights and shops. Obviously there are more bus stops but you will probably have to change buses to get where you want, which can be inconvenient. You will find that the buses are mainly in the central areas but some tube lines go quite a long way out of London so you could use this for longer journeys. Having said that, the tubes do get very crowded so you should use the train if you want to sit down. It does depend where you're travelling to.

Student: Well, I'm living on the outskirts but I have to travel into London to college everyday and then around London when I'm here.

Man: OK, so time is going to be an issue for you. The tube should be fast crossing London, but quite honestly, there are so many delays that it's not very efficient. Again, the train has fewer stops so is probably your quickest option to get to and from college. Of course, which service you use might depend on how frequent it is. I mean, the trains might only be every twenty minutes or whatever, but a timetable is published to save you hanging around. There are a lot of tube trains at busy times of day, but fewer at other times whereas the buses run every five minutes through most of the day and there are night buses. But you'll need to check out your route first.

Student: OK, thanks. How can I get from here to Hackney, then?

Man: Right, well you can choose. We're here at the information office, OK? Now, next to us, on the corner of the high street and Sweet Street is the bus stop, opposite the bank. The bus goes all the way to Hackney but it is a very indirect route so it could take ages. If you want to take the train, walk down the high street towards the city, go past the bank and on your left is the station, just before you get to the post office. There's a mainline service to Hackney Wick so, if you need to get into the centre of Hackney, you may need to pick up a bus when you get there. Opposite the post office, on the corner of Heart Lane is the tube entrance – you'll see the big signs. That's probably the best way to get there, though you may have to change. It's probably best if you go and get a travel card first. To get to the ticket office, you go out of here onto the high street. Then turn into South Street and the ticket office is on your right opposite the cinema. Of course, you may decide it's quicker to take a taxi. But, it's a long way so I think it'll be very expensive. If you do want to get a cab, then the rank is outside here just opposite the office.



## SECTION 3

**You will hear two medical students, Caitlin and Hideki, discussing options for courses.**

Caitlin: Hi, Hideki. How are you?

Hideki: Fine. I'm glad I bumped into you. Have you got five minutes to sit down and discuss our extra course options for next term?

Caitlin: Yes, sure. You mean the support courses for our modules?

Hideki: Yes. We've got three choices and I'm not sure which would be best for us to do.

Caitlin: Let's have a look. Yeah – we could do Science and Ethics – sounds quite interesting.

Hideki: Yes – but I think we should be thinking what we get out of each course. So Science and Ethics – there's a lot of reading and research to do. And I don't think it comes up in the exams, does it?

Caitlin: Um – I'm not sure. Er – oh, I see we have to do assignments and we get our score from that. But what it would do is to force us to get better at doing essays and reports – you know, organising them and using the right kind of language. Might be worthwhile?

Hideki: Yeah, you're right. An alternative is the Pharmacology Prelim course. I think it's in case we want to go on to transfer to Pharmacology at the end of the year because lots of students do. So it depends what we want to do in the future, but apparently they send you off to find out about various companies and the differences between their products – it would give you lots of practice in investigative studies and analysis. I think I'd quite enjoy that.

Caitlin: Yes, I see your point. Um, then the other option is Reporting Test Results – sounds a bit boring. Not sure why they have a separate course just for that?

Hideki: Well, I could certainly do with some help in that because if you go out into industry, that's what you'll spend most of your time doing, so it's got a very practical application. I think I'm going to go for Pharmacology.

Caitlin: Me too.

Hideki: So let's have a look at it in more detail. Oh, goodness – if we do Pharmacology then we have to do a supplementary Maths course.

Caitlin: Oh no – that's not fair. Mind you, I think I need it. Does that mean we have twice as many lectures?

Hideki: No, this Maths is only a short course. The Chemistry department are responsible and they do it in the third term. So we've got all next term to settle into the Pharmacology bit.

Caitlin: I find the tutor makes a real difference – some of them make Chemistry so easy and some of them I can't understand at all – like that one we had from Oxford University. Mind you, the one on this course should make sense because he's a lecturer who's coming in for a few weeks from industry so at least it'll be linked to the real world!

Hideki: Yeah. The project we have to do on this pharmacology course is huge and it doesn't give us much time. We have to make a decision about what we want to do on the project as soon as we start in January, and then hand in our plans before the end of the month!

Caitlin: Doesn't give us much time to sort out what's possible or not. I mean, doesn't the scale of our project depend on what resources we can have, like what equipment we can use?

Hideki: I suppose so, though I think there's plenty available. For example, it says that if we need to do any experiments, then we can use all the equipment in the new lab, as long as we book it.

Caitlin: Oh, OK. It's slowly beginning to take shape for me. I think it'll be a good course. I'm just worried that I get enough support to do it.

Hideki: I think you'll be OK. And the tutors are always available if you get stuck.

Caitlin: Actually it says that if you're not sure, then, in December, they'll be running one or two additional seminars – so I might go to those.

Hideki: Actually, what's quite interesting is that at the end of the course, when our project is completed, then we have to do a presentation on it. I think that's quite good practice.

Caitlin: Bit scary though!



Hideki: Well, it shouldn't be too bad as they say that we can do it in pairs. Spread the load, as it were!

Caitlin: Oh, good. I have done presentations before but I'm always very nervous. And is the presentation what we're assessed on then?

Hideki: Let me look .... um ... Ah, it says that we have an interview and we get a mark for the whole course depending on how well we do in that.

Caitlin: Right ... (fade) ...

## SECTION 4

### You will hear part of a lecture on cities of the future.

M: OK, we've been looking at how societies will develop in the future and at the increase in the size of cities, so I want to talk to you today about the key considerations in these cities of the future. There are three key elements I want to look at and these are the new features they will have, issues of size and the main problems to be considered. First of all, individual transportation will be a big factor in these new mega cities as public transport becomes unmanageable. There'll be a huge rise in the use of Segways, which are personal transporters like motorised scooters. As a result, and partly also to reduce pollution, roads will be altered so that they are narrower and will take up less of a city's space than they do currently. Naturally, this is a major change to the infrastructure and something that may hinder it is the huge amount of investment it will require. The next thing is, what is going to happen to the commercial areas? We do not want these to become even larger concrete jungles than they are at present so we have to look at design, and current designs for city development include building gardens on the roofs of these buildings to make a more pleasant environment for workers. And you may think that these areas will expand to cope with increased commercial activity. In fact, the prediction is that they will cover one fifth of the area that they do at present as we build upwards. The exception to this is shopping centres, which we predict will expand with more and more temperature controlled malls. What may cause difficulties is that the superstores will be confined to the outer edges of the city as they will be too big to fit into the new malls. Then, of course, there are the residential areas and these will undergo their own changes. One particular development will be houses which are built from glass, as innovations in this material allow it to provide light without causing problems with temperature inside a building. The residential areas will not be allowed to expand without limit, as happens in some areas at present, and their size will be restricted to a population of 15,000. One issue which has yet to be resolved, and I'm not sure it ever will be, is how we manage to house older residents. They will be increasing in numbers as time goes on. Finally, how will these cities live? We know we have limited energy sources so what will we do? Well, something currently in development which will be a feature, is that waste is going to become an energy source, for example, to provide gas in homes. Also as new technology and systems are developed we will find that energy plants will become smaller. Another energy source we could use, but one which raises issues of having enough space and too much noise is windfarms. Because of the problems, I'm not convinced these will be the grand solution to our energy problems that we thought they were going to be.

Now, moving on to looking at the social aspect of cities, we need to look at housing and how people will live. Cities currently have flats in the centre populated by single people and wealthier residents, and families tend to move to the outskirts. In the future, the centre of cities will see a dramatic change. We will see many more examples of co-operative buildings. This is where people join together to form a company that owns the building they live in. And, despite continuing shortages, there will also be a rise in the provision of retirement homes in city centres so that the elderly can have easy access to hospitals and shops. Recently, we have seen a levelling off in the growth of private housing and I think that will not change, but we are likely to see more social housing as far fewer people will be able to afford to own their own homes.

OK, now, if anybody ... (fade) ...



## AUDIOSCRIPT

### SECTION 1

**You will hear a woman asking a shop assistant about DVD players.**

- Customer: Hello. I'm interested in buying a DVD player. Can you help me as I don't know very much about them.
- Shop assistant: Of course. We sell quite a range. Actually, we're doing a customer survey at the moment. So I wonder if I could fill in this form about you and that will actually help me to advise you on the best DVD player for you.
- Customer: OK ...
- Shop assistant: First of all, your occupation?
- Customer: Um – student.
- Shop assistant: OK. Then, have you already got a DVD player?
- Customer: No. I've never had one before.
- Shop assistant: And how much do you think you want to spend on a player?
- Customer: I'm not sure really – but I have got a budget. My friend said I should allow about £100 but I can't afford over £85, so that's what I'm working on.
- Shop assistant: And do you watch DVDs very often?
- Customer: Um – depends what you mean by often. I don't know what the norm is – is it about two a week?
- I suppose I watch three a month. That's enough for me!
- Shop assistant: Yes (laughs). What sort of films do you like watching then? Action movies?
- Customer: (laughs) Not really. My boyfriend always insists we watch science-fiction movies but I prefer thrillers. Something to get your teeth into!
- Shop assistant: OK. Just one more. Do you watch other DVDs – ones that are not films – like music or something?
- Customer: Not much because I don't want to spend the money on something I can watch on TV but I occasionally rent out comedy programmes. And I fight with my boyfriend over all the sports DVDs he watches.
- Shop assistant: OK. Let me explain a bit to you about the DVD players that are in your price range. First there's the DB 30 which has only got basic features but it is a bargain at £69. Now all the DVDs come with an after-sales service that starts when the guarantee runs out. As it's so cheap the DB30 comes with a limited after-sales service as it only includes parts. You would have to pay for most of the repair.
- Customer: Seems OK.
- Shop assistant: Then a slight grade up from that is the XL 643. This comes with an additional feature in that it has an extra button allowing you to record. That's quite useful.
- Customer: Oh yes. That would mean spending less on DVDs to watch.
- Shop assistant: Yes, so you'd make the extra money back on it that it costs. Let me see how much it is ... ah, yes, that one's actually reduced at the moment – from £79 to £71.99. I think it's worth the extra myself.
- Customer: And is that the same level of after-sales service as the other one?
- Shop assistant: Well, you get a bit more for your money because what we are offering is a discount on labour. So you don't pay the full price if you have to call an engineer out.
- Customer: I see.
- Shop assistant: Then the last one is this TriX 24. It's a very good player and you can use it to listen to your CDs as well as watch DVDs.
- Customer: It looks nice – but I bet it's expensive.



Shop assistant: No, it's not top of the range. Let's see – yes it's £94 – but, what you have to remember is that, that includes insurance, so you don't have to pay extra for that. And it comes with a guarantee that's valid for three years as opposed to the usual one. What do you think?

Customer: Hm, maybe ... (fade) ...

## SECTION 2

**You will hear a salesman giving information to house owners about an alarm system.**

Salesman: Thank you for inviting me to your residents meeting. My name is Martin Pugh from Safe Sell Alarms. I'm going to explain a little bit about home security and I hope you'll all feel a bit better informed and perhaps that you will even purchase one of the alarms we sell. It is all too easy these days for people to break in to our homes. Did you know that 25% of all burglaries are committed by burglars breaking and entering via the back door? Even though it is locked, it is still relatively easy for someone to gain entry. And there are parts of our house that we think are not vulnerable because they look inaccessible – but they're not. So, if you're trying to protect your home, you should make the sure top floor is covered by that protection, not just the ground floor. We believe that the only way to secure your property is by having an alarm fitted. Just having the alarm on the outside can put burglars off and we also recommend that you warn them about the alarm. To do this, we suggest you stick a sign in the front window of the house so it can be seen clearly. This alone should be enough to dissuade a burglar before they start.

Now, our company has a range of alarms on offer and I've brought several along for you to see tonight. But let me just explain a few things about them. First of all, all of our alarms are highly visible. They're coloured red and, on the underneath, there is a blue light, which you can see whether they are switched on or not. This acts as a deterrent to burglars who can see it is an active alarm system. Like most systems, our alarms are very sensitive so you do need to look after them. You may be surprised to hear that a cat can often slink around unnoticed under the infrared beams but a spider crawling across them will set them off. Also, our system is a little different from some. Most companies offer an option that connects their alarms to the police station. All our alarms have an automatic link to our company office. This means we can deal with the situation promptly and can sort out any alarms that have gone off by mistake.

OK, let me tell you about the installation of our alarms. Later on I'll show you some house plans and diagrams of how the alarms operate but you don't have to worry about them being intrusive, as we normally put them in hallways rather than individual rooms. The diagrams show you how the beams work to cover the whole house in this way. Oh, one small thing while I remember, is don't leave your security code in your house – a lot of people keep it in the kitchen or their study but we suggest you leave it with a neighbour so that if there is a break in, the burglars can't switch the system off. Now, regarding the practical aspects of installation – I know that many of you are out all day and I'm afraid we don't install the alarms at weekends, but we do offer a service where we can fit the alarm system in the evenings for you but we do charge a little bit extra for that. Finally, we do offer a range of systems, so I suggest you look at the leaflets on our prices. And please don't be put off from investing in a more sophisticated system to protect your home as we do allow you to set up a monthly payment if it's too much in one go. OK, now, if you'd like to ... (fade) ...



## SECTION 3

**You will hear a student, Alex, asking his tutor for advice about essay writing.**

Tutor: Hi, Alex, come in. I gather you wanted some help with writing essays.

Alex: Yes. I'm finding this first term difficult and I'm worried about the assignments we have to do for January.

Tutor: Well, let me see if I can help. You shouldn't panic about it because essay writing is a very straightforward process really. What it involves is organising the information that you want to include. You shouldn't have more than you can easily manage within the word count. Make sure you haven't got too much or anything irrelevant. You need to look at that and work out what you need and what you don't need before you start. And then you just have to think about how you're going to put forward your argument.

Alex: Oh, that sounds very straightforward when you put it like that. But I'm worried I haven't got the necessary skills for writing an effective essay because English is my second language.

Tutor: Well, perhaps you misunderstand the skills you need. You need to be able to analyse your data and then I would say the skills of interpretation and expressing yourself are important. Perhaps it's this last one that bothers you, but the more essays you write, the more you will develop these skills.

Alex: Yes – and I don't quite know how to improve at that – though as you say, I know practice will help. And I need to make sure I've got everything ready before I start.

Tutor: Yes. What is vital to good essay writing is preparation so make sure you build in enough time to do the research you need.

Alex: Are there any other sources I can use to help me with essays?

Tutor: Yes. You should go to the library and look through the reference section because there are books that focus on the style we use in academic writing and those will help you a lot. The other thing that you should think about is, what happens when you've actually written your essay. Too many students just complete their work and hand it in, whereas what you should be doing is making sure that you edit it as thoroughly as possible.

Alex: Oh, yes. That's a good idea. Then I'd pick up any mistakes and also see if it reads logically.

Tutor: Exactly. The other thing is, again, what a lot of students do is get their essays back, look at the marks, then just file it away. They don't seem to realise that if they checked it through and looked at what the tutor had written, then they can learn from their old essays.

Alex: Yeah, I can see that's a good idea.

Tutor: So, is that OK? You can always come back to me.

Alex: Actually, there were a couple of other things I wanted to ask you about essay writing. I had had a few thoughts of my own about what I should do such as really taking good notes when I'm reading because that helps, doesn't it?

Tutor: I think it improves your knowledge rather than your actual writing. But one tip I can give you is to try and not read too much, otherwise you end up including irrelevant material in your essay. Remember to stay on task.

Alex: Yes, sometimes I have problems interpreting the questions correctly, or the whole question seems overwhelming to me. What I try to do is highlight the key parts and divide it into smaller chunks, so I can manage it.

Tutor: Well, you might find it useful to break it down even further by making sure you understand all the words perfectly before you start. Things like 'assess' or 'comment' and such like.

Alex: Yes, I see.

Tutor: Sometimes, after an objective analysis, the question actually asks you for a subjective opinion, but you must remember to support your arguments, if that's the case. One final comment I can make is about using your own words – you must try to do this as far as possible. You're expected to summarise what you've read not just string together a list of quotations. In fact, you shouldn't have too many – just use them where it's really important.



Alex: OK, thanks.  
Tutor: Do you read other student's essays when you've finished?  
Alex: No. Why? Is that a good idea?  
Tutor: Well, you can confuse each other so I'd advise against it – but it's up to you.  
Alex: OK. Thanks very much ... (fade) ...

## SECTION 4

**You will hear a tutor giving some Business students instructions about a finance project.**

Tutor: OK, can you quieten down please? Now, today, I'm going to talk to you about your assignment. We've been studying the effects of the exchange rate so I'm going to give you a project to do on this. Right, can you make some notes while I'm talking. The first thing that I'd like you to do in order to prepare this is to select where you're interested in, I mean, which country, and therefore which currency you're going to be operating in. OK, now the purpose of the project is to make money and I'm hoping some of you will make a significant amount! So I want you to suppose that you have £100 that you will have to invest purely in the rises and falls of the exchange system. In other words, you'll be trying to predict rates. This is a project that you'll be doing together but, before you work together, you'll have to go off and research what you need to know about the economy of that country and how well it's doing or is expected to do in the near future. You could all make up a little information sheet with your notes on, clearly legible, because then I want you to get together – we can do that next week – and to go round and read about each other's countries. When you see how well or badly each country is doing, I want you to decide what your exchange rate is going to be against all the other currencies. After that is all sorted, what you're going to do is to go round the other students and attempt to sell your money to the others – remember this will depend on the success of your country's economy and the rate you've fixed for your currency. Now, you're not allowed to just swap currencies with each other but you may wish to buy from the other countries – but you must do a proper transaction. All the way through this you must keep your accounts properly for each transaction. I'll give you one week to do this and then we will set a time for the deals to finish – a bit like the stock exchange – and, at that point, I will ask you to calculate how much you have made. Is that clear?

OK, now before you begin that, there are a few things I want you to read up on to prepare. You need to look at the economies of the UK's main trading partners. I don't mean all of them because that would be over 80, but just the 29 principal ones. There are summaries in the last three books on the booklist I've given you. And so that you can practise applying the criteria on assessment I gave you, I'd then like you to focus just on one sector across all the countries. The most common one across every country is farming but, as much agricultural produce is for domestic consumption, I'd like you to look at manufacturing. Then, I would like you to do a detailed investigation of one particular aspect. I was going to give you a choice but I think, as we've just started the course, it's better if we all look at the same thing and then we can discuss it in the seminars. So the thing I'd like you all to look at is fluctuations in import prices. Now you need to do all that before you start the project as it will help you assess the economies of the countries you'll be representing in the project. Don't worry – you've got plenty of time. Exam week is December 8th, then it's the holidays until January 6<sup>th</sup> so I don't need the project in till February 5<sup>th</sup>. Is that OK? Now, any questions ... (fade) ...